

Project XTC

Working Paper 008

Chapter 8 – The Scribble Strips: Small Displays, Big Clues

If the V-Pots are the fingertips of the X-Touch, the scribble strips are its eyes. Many owners glance at them only long enough to confirm track names. DrivenByMoss turns them into one of the controller's most valuable sources of information.

They Tell You What Will Happen

Before touching a control, look at the display above it. In Mixer mode it may show a track name and pan value. In Device mode it changes to parameter names. In Browser mode it becomes a navigation aid. The scribble strip answers the question: 'What am I about to change?'

Reduce Guesswork

A common beginner habit is to turn an encoder first and watch the computer screen afterwards. Experienced users reverse that process: they read the scribble strip, then make a deliberate adjustment. It is faster and avoids accidental edits.

Aha!

The displays are not merely labels. They are part of the conversation between Bitwig and the controller. As the current context changes, the displays change with it, guiding your next action without requiring the mouse.

Workflow Example

Select a track containing Polymer. Enter Device mode. Notice how every scribble strip changes from track information to synthesiser parameters. Without opening the plug-in window, you already know what each V-Pot controls.

Key Takeaways

- Read before you reach.
- The scribble strips describe the current context.
- If the labels change unexpectedly, you've probably changed track or mode—not broken anything.